University of Florida
College of Public Health & Health Professions
PHC 6003: Epidemiology and Prevention of Chronic Disease and Disability (3 credit hours)
Fall 2025
Delivery Format: In-person and remote
Syllabus

Instructor Name: Stephen Kimmel, MD, MSCE
Email Addresses: skimmel@ufl.edu
Graduate Assistant: Upuli Dissanayake upulid@ufl.edu : Monday 2:30PM – 3:30PM or by appt.
Preferred Course Communications: Email: correspondence should copy Dr. Kimmel.

Prerequisites
Introductory Epidemiology Course preferred or by consent of instructor.

Course Overview

This course will focus on the distribution and determents of major chronic diseases and their risk factors. Chronic diseases have been the leading cause of mortality for over 100 years and contribute to the majority of disability and health care visits in the US and the rest of the industrialized world. The list of individual chronic diseases of public health importance is extensive. This course will focus on conceptual and methodological issues related to the study of most chronic diseases. Cardiovascular disease and cancer will be the models for many of the epidemiologic examples used in this course, due to the extensive and established nature of their evidence base. The concepts and methods illustrated are pertinent to most other chronic diseases, and individual courses on their epidemiology can be taken for disease-specific content.

Relation to Program Objectives
1. Assess potential confounders in epidemiology studies
2. Evaluate interaction, effect modification and mediation in epidemiology studies
3. Evaluate the multifactorial etiology and pathophysiology of chronic diseases
4. Interpret results of data analysis for public health research, policy or practice

Course Objectives and/or Goals
1. To understand the multifactorial etiology and pathophysiology of chronic diseases.
2. To know the various epidemiologic study designs and their strengths/weaknesses in the study of etiology and natural history of chronic diseases.
3. To be able to define incident and prevalent cases of select chronic diseases, using traditional and clinical epidemiologic research methods.
4. To understand the concept of “risk factor” as it pertains to chronic diseases and the means to define them.
5. To be able to assess the evidence base for interventions at the individual and community levels which reduce the risk of chronic disease incidence and mortality.
6. To understand how epidemiologic studies of chronic disease are translated into diagnosis, treatment and prevention programs and policies.
7. To be able to read, interpret, and critique published reports of epidemiologic studies of chronic disease.

Instructional Methods

1. **Lectures**: This is an online, synchronous course that includes weekly lectures, take home essays, final essay, and participation in a team presentation.

2. **Readings**: Assigned readings in the required textbook or published literature are intended to supplement the lectures. Additional readings may be added during the course.

3. **Assignments**:
   a) In-class discussion: Students will be required to engage in the discussions during classes.

   b) Take home essay tests. Two take home essays (take home essay #1 and #2) will be required but following their grading and review, will also be the topic of discussion.

   c) Leadership of Class Discussion on Papers: Student groups will present critique of assigned reading each week (unless that week is used for other purpose). They will present a formal overview of the paper and then provide questions for the class to answer based on their presentation (using online survey tool, Kahoot!) followed by a question and class debate on whether the class believes the paper adequately answers the study hypothesis

   d) Team presentations: This will be the final exam presentation for the course. In teams of 2-4 students, a twenty-minute presentation will focus on a topic regarding a major chronic disease. The student teams will obtain preapproval of the topic by course director/graduate assistant and submit an organized twenty-minute presentation. Each student should participate equally in the presentation.

   e) Final essay: The final essay (take home essay #3) will consist of review of a scientific paper.

What is expected of you?

You are expected to actively engage in the course throughout the semester. You must come to class prepared by completing all out-of-class assignments. This preparation gives you the knowledge or practice needed to engage in higher levels of learning during the live class sessions. If you are not prepared for the face-to-face sessions, you may struggle to keep pace with the activities occurring in the live sessions, and it is unlikely that you will reach the higher learning goals of the course. Similarly, you are expected to actively participate in the live class. Your participation fosters a rich course experience for you and your peers that facilitates overall mastery of the course objectives.

Completion of the assigned readings from this text is mandatory. Other readings will be selected from articles published in peer reviewed journals. Lecture presentations will highlight, review, and expand upon the most important aspects of the assigned reading materials. Students are still responsible for mastering any content from the assigned readings, exercises, or assignments that is NOT covered in a lecture presentation.

PHC 6003 Epidemiology of Chronic Disease and Disability Topical Outline/Course Schedule

Week/Date	Topic	Lecturer	Required Reading	In-Class Discussion
Week 1 Thursday, August 21	• Course Introduction • Review of Syllabus • Review presentation expectations	Dr. Kimmel TA		Task: Complete group sign-up in Canvas before end of class

Week 2 Thursday, Aug 28	• Global Burden of Chronic Disease • Biology of Chronic Disease: Atherosclerosis	Dr. Kimmel	US Burden of Disease (1) Harris R., Chapter 1, 3	Paper Critique and Discussion: Dwyer-Lindgren, L, Bertozzi-Villa A, et al. US County-Level Trends in Mortality Rates for Major Causes of Death, 1980-2014. JAMA 2016; 316:2385-2401 (2)
Week 3 Thursday, Sept 4	• How do we know that chronic disease is preventable? • Interrupted Time Series • Florida Population "Databases and UF Libguide	Dr. Kimmel	Harris R., Chapter 2	Paper Critique and Discussion: Gupta et al. Association of the Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program Implementation With Readmission and Mortality Outcomes in Heart Failure (3)
Week 4 Thursday, Sept 11	• Smoking • Epidemiology of Smoking and CVD/Cancer • Second-hand smoke	Dr. Kimmel	Harris R., Chapter 13 Hackshaw et al. The accumulated evidence on lung cancer and environmental tobacco smoke. BMJ. 1997 Oct 18; 315(7114):980-8.	Paper Critique and Discussion: Wills TA et al. E-cigarette use and respiratory disorders: an integrative review of converging evidence from epidemiological and laboratory studies. Eur Respir J. 2021 Jan 21;57(1):1901815. O'Brien D et al Association between electronic cigarette use and tobacco cigarette smoking initiation in adolescents: a systematic review and meta-analysis. BMC Public Health. 2021 Jun 3;21(1):954.
Week 5 Thursday, Sept 18	• Randomized Clinical Trials • Randomized trial in CAD • Selection of Topic for Team Report	Dr. Pepine	CANTOS Trial Harris R. (chapter relevant to team report)	Paper Critique and Discussion: Ridker PM, et al. anti-inflammatory Therapy with Canakinumab for Atherosclerotic Disease NEJM 2017; 377:1119-1131 *Identify team final topic **Take Home Essay #1 assigned & discussion of expectations**
Week 6 Thursday, Sept 25	• Exercise • Triggering of MI • Exercise and sudden death)	Dr. Kimmel		**TAKE HOME ESSAY #1 Due 11:58 PM** Paper Critique and Discussion: Mittleman MA et al. Triggering of acute myocardial infarction by heavy physical exertion. Protection against triggering by regular exertion. Determinants of Myocardial Infarction Onset Study Investigators. N Engl J Med. 1993 Dec 2;329(23):1677-83.
Week 7 Thursday, Oct 2	• Social Determinants of Health • Cardiovascular Disease and Socioeconomic Correlates	Dr. Vaddiparti	Min YI, et al. Cardiovascular Disease Burden and Socioeconomic Correlates: Findings From the Jackson Heart Study. J Am Heart Assoc. 2017 Aug 4;6(8)	Hands-on experience with Florida Cancer Incidence https://www.flhealthcharts.gov/ChartsReports/rdPage.aspx?rdReport=NonVitalInd.DataViewer&cid=460

Week 8 Thursday, Oct 9	• Competing Risks in Aging: The Epidemiologic Paradox of Cancer, Dementia, and Treatment-Related Cognitive Decline	Dr. Karanth	<u>Required (both):</u> Mandelblatt JS et al. Cancer-Related Cognitive Outcomes Among Older Breast Cancer Survivors in the Thinking and Living With Cancer Study. J Clin Oncol. 2018 Oct 3;36(32) Karanth, S. D., Katsumata, Y., Nelson, P. T., Fardo, D. W., McDowell, J. K., Schmitt, F. A., ... & Abner, E. L. (2022). Cancer diagnosis is associated with a lower burden of dementia and less Alzheimer's-type neuropathology. Brain, 145(7), 2518-2527.	<u>Paper Critique and Discussion:</u> Chamberlain JD et al. Investigating the association between cancer and the risk of dementia: Results from the Memento cohort. Alzheimers Dement. 2021 Sep;17(9):1415-1421.
Week 9 Thursday, Oct 16	• Introduction to Cancer Epidemiology	Dr. Mai	Harris R., Chapters 11, 12 Tomasetti. Stem cell divisions, somatic mutations, cancer etiology, and cancer prevention. Science 355, 1330–1334 (2017)	<u>Be prepared to discuss with Dr. Mai:</u> Tomasetti. Stem cell divisions, somatic mutations, cancer etiology, and cancer prevention. Science 355, 1330–1334 (2017) **Discussion of Take-Home Essay #1**
Week 10 Thursday, Oct 23	• Breast Cancer	Dr. Lusi	Harris R., Chapter 21 Danny R. Youlden, Susanna M. Cramb, Nathan A.M. Dunn, Jennifer M. Muller, Christopher M. Pyke, Peter D. Baade, The descriptive epidemiology of female breast cancer: An international comparison of screening, incidence, survival and mortality, Cancer Epidemiology, Volume 36, Issue 3, 2012, Pages 237-248 Hiatt, R. A. and J. G. Brody (2018). "Environmental Determinants of Breast Cancer." Annual Review of Public Health 39(Volume 39, 2018): 113-133	**Take Home Essay #2 assigned & discussion of expectations**
Week 11 Thursday, Oct 30	• Cannabis use and chronic pain	Dr. Wang	<u>Required:</u> Romero-Sandoval EA, Fincham JE, Kolano AL, Sharpe BN, Alvarado-Vázquez PA. Cannabis for Chronic Pain: Challenges and Considerations. Pharmacotherapy. 2018 Jun;38(6):651-662. doi: 10.1002/phar.2115. Epub 2018 May 16. PMID: 29637590.	<u>Paper Critique and Discussion:</u> McDonagh MS, Morasco BJ, Wagner J, Ahmed AY, Fu R, Kansagara D, Chou R. Cannabis-Based Products for Chronic Pain : A Systematic Review. Ann Intern Med. 2022 Aug;175(8):1143-1153. doi: 10.7326/M21-4520. Epub 2022 Jun 7. PMID: 35667066 **TAKE HOME ESSAY #2 Due 11:58 PM**

Week 12 Thursday, Nov 6	**Final Team Presentations DAY 1 (in-class)** Groups presenting on this day must upload final version of presentation slides to Canvas by 2:59 PM on Nov 6th (start of class)			
Week 13 Thursday, Nov 13	• Chronicity X3: Mental Health Disorders Are, Increase Risk for and Accompany Chronic Diseases (CD)Mental health epi	Dr. Striley	Adzrago D, Williams DR, Williams F. Multiple chronic diseases and psychological distress among adults in the United States: the intersectionality of chronic diseases, race/ethnicity, immigration, sex, and insurance coverage. Soc Psychiatry Psychiatry Epidemiol. Published online July 17, 2024. doi:10.1007/s00127-024-02730-1	**Discussion of Take-Home Essay #2** Paper Critique and Discussion: Liu NH, et al. Excess mortality in persons with severe mental disorders: a multilevel intervention framework and priorities for clinical practice, policy and research agendas. World Psychiatry. 2017;16(1):30-40. doi:10.1002/wps.20384 **Take Home Essay #3 assigned & discussion of expectations**
Week 14 Thursday, Nov 20	**Final Team Presentations DAY 2 (in-class)** Groups presenting on this day must upload final version presentation slides to Canvas by 2:59 PM on Nov 20th (start of class) **Final Essay DUE WEDNESDAY Dec 3rd by 11:59 AM → (due at noon; not in the evening)** ** This is the final live class session for the semester! ** Please continue to monitor Canvas regarding all remaining assignments due after Nov 20th.			
Week 15 Thursday, Nov 27	WEEK OF THANKSGIVING BREAK			

Course Instructors and Invited Lecturers

- Stephen E. Kimmel, MD, MSCE
- Carl Pepine, MD
- Krishna Vaddiparti, PhD, MPE, MSW
- Shama Karanth, PhD, MDS
- Shantrel Candidate, PhD, MPH
- Catherine Striley, PhD, MSW, MPE
- Volker Mai, PhD, MPH
- Yan Wang, PhD, MS

Course Materials and Technology Requirements

The required text: Epidemiology of Chronic Diseases: Global Perspectives, Randall E. Harris, Publisher: Jones & Bartlett Learning, ISBN: 9781449653286

Articles and other resources will be posted on e-Learning

The US Burden of Disease Collaborators. The State of US Health, 1990-2016. JAMA 2017;l 319:1444-1472.

Dwyer-Lindgren, L, Bertozzi-Villa A, et al. US County-Level Trends in Mortality Rates for Major Causes of Death, 1980-2014. JAMA 2016; 316:2385-2401

Gupta et al. Association of the Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program Implementation With Readmission and Mortality Outcomes in Heart Failure. JAMA Cardiol. 2018 Jan 1;3(1):44-53

Hackshaw et al. The accumulated evidence on lung cancer and environmental tobacco smoke. BMJ. 1997 Oct 18; 315(7114):980-8.

Wills TA et al. E-cigarette use and respiratory disorders: an integrative review of converging evidence from epidemiological and laboratory studies. Eur Respir J. 2021 Jan 21;57(1):1901815.

O'Brien D et a Association between electronic cigarette use and tobacco cigarette smoking initiation in adolescents: a systematic review and meta-analysis. BMC Public Health. 2021 Jun 3;21(1):954.

Ridker PM, et al. Anti-inflammatory Therapy with Canakinumab for Atherosclerotic Disease NEJM 2017; 377:1119-1131

Mittleman MA et al. Triggering of acute myocardial infarction by heavy physical exertion. Protection against triggering by regular exertion. Determinants of Myocardial Infarction Onset Study Investigators. N Engl J Med. 1993 Dec 2;329(23):1677-83.

Cancer Staging, Chapter 14 (Cancer Registry Management, Principles and Practices for hospitals and central registries, third edition)

Bray F, Znaor A, Cueva P, Korir A, Swaminathan R, Ullrich A, Wang SA, Parkin DM. Planning and developing population-based cancer registration in low-and middle-income settings. International Agency for Research on Cancer, 2014.

Planning and Developing Population-Based Cancer Registration in Low- and Middle-Income Settings. http://publications.iarc.fr/Book-And-Report-Series/Iarc-Technical-Publications/Planning-And-Developing-Population-Based-Cancer-Registration-In-Low--And-Middle-Income-Settings-2014

Min YI, et al. Cardiovascular Disease Burden and Socioeconomic Correlates: Findings From the Jackson Heart Study. J Am Heart Assoc. 2017 Aug 4;6(8)

Discrimination and Hypertension Risk Among African Americans in the Jackson Heart Study. Hypertension. 2020 Sep;76(3):715-723.

Romero-Sandoval EA, Fincham JE, Kolano AL, Sharpe BN, Alvarado-Vázquez PA. Cannabis for Chronic Pain: Challenges and Considerations. Pharmacotherapy. 2018 Jun;38(6):651-662. doi: 10.1002/phar.2115. Epub 2018 May 16. PMID: 29637590.

McDonagh MS, Morasco BJ, Wagner J, Ahmed AY, Fu R, Kansagara D, Chou R. Cannabis-Based Products for Chronic Pain : A Systematic Review. Ann Intern Med. 2022 Aug;175(8):1143-1153. doi: 10.7326/M21-4520. Epub 2022 Jun 7. PMID: 35667066.

Danny R. Youlden, Susanna M. Cramb, Nathan A.M. Dunn, Jennifer M. Muller, Christopher M. Pyke, Peter D. Baade, The descriptive epidemiology of female breast cancer: An international comparison of screening, incidence, survival and mortality, Cancer Epidemiology, Volume 36, Issue 3, 2012, Pages 237-248

Hiatt, R. A. and J. G. Brody (2018). "Environmental Determinants of Breast Cancer." Annual Review of Public Health 39(Volume 39, 2018): 113-133

Bethea TN, Rosenberg L, Hong CC, Troester MA, Lunetta KL, Bandera EV, Schedin P, Kolonel LN, Olshan AF, Ambrosone CB, Palmer JR. A case-control analysis of oral contraceptive use and breast cancer subtypes in the African American Breast Cancer Epidemiology and Risk Consortium. Breast Cancer Res. 2015 Feb 21;17(1):22.

Mendenhall E, Kohrt BA, Norris SA, Ndetei D, Prabhakaran D. Non-communicable disease syndemics: poverty, depression, and diabetes among low-income populations. The Lancet. 2017 Mar 4;389(10072):951-63.

Rodriguez VJ, Chahine A, Parrish MS, Alcaide ML, Lee TK, Hurwitz B, Sawhney M, Weiss SM, Jones DL, Kumar M. The contribution of syndemic conditions to cardiovascular disease risk. AIDS care. 2021 May 4;33(5):585-93.)

Singer M, Bulled N, Ostrach B, Mendenhall E. Syndemics and the biosocial conception of health. The lancet. 2017 Mar 4;389(10072):941-50.Liu NH, et al. Excess mortality in persons with severe mental disorders: a multilevel intervention framework and priorities for clinical practice, policy and research agendas. World Psychiatry. 2017;16(1):30-40. doi:10.1002/wps.20384

Adzrago D, Williams DR, Williams F. Multiple chronic diseases and psychological distress among adults in the United States: the intersectionality of chronic diseases, race/ethnicity, immigration, sex, and insurance coverage. Soc Psychiatry Psychiatr Epidemiol. Published online July 17, 2024. doi:10.1007/s00127-024-02730-1

Tomasetti C, Li L, Vogelstein B. Stem cell divisions, somatic mutations, cancer etiology, and cancer prevention. Science. 2017 Mar 24;355(6331):1330-4.

Required Equipment

Computer with high-speed internet access and use of a supported browser. Please refer to the student computing requirements listed on the Online Student Resources page.

Technical Support

For technical support for this class, please contact the UF Help Desk at:

- helpdesk@ufl.edu
- (352) 392-HELP - select option 2
- https://helpdesk.ufl.edu/

Additional Academic Resources

Career Connections Center: Reitz Union Suite 1300, 352-392-1601. Career assistance and counseling services.

Library Support: Various ways to receive assistance with respect to using the libraries or finding resources.

Teaching Center: Broward Hall, 352-392-2010 or to make an appointment 352- 392-6420. General study skills and tutoring.

Writing Studio*:* 2215 Turlington Hall*,* 352-846-1138. Help brainstorming, formatting, and writing papers.

Student Complaints On-Campus: Visit the Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code webpage for more information.

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

The evaluation of student performance in PHC 6003 will consist of four parts:

Final essay (Take Home Essay #3): (25%) The final essay will consist of review of a scientific paper.

Two take-home essay tests: (20% total → 10% per essay) This will be an open-book test with essay format. These essays will test comprehension and skill objectives for the course. Individual essays will be graded with comments and a discussion for student questions will be held two weeks after the examination is submitted**.**

Leadership of Class Discussion on Papers: (20%) Student groups will present critique of assigned reading each week (unless that week is used for other purpose). They will present a formal overview of the paper and then provide questions for the class to answer based on their presentation (using online

survey tool, Kahoot!) followed by a question and class debate on whether the class believes the paper adequately answers the study hypothesis.

Team presentations: (20%) These will be a 20 minute oral presentation by teams of 2-4 students. Team will be asked to present a formal discussion of an issue in the chronic disease of their choice, according to those chapters in the Harris et al textbook. The same grade will be given to all members of the team unless all students do not contribute to the presentation. This will assess the comprehension skills and learning objectives.

Class Discussion: (15%) This will assess engagement of the student in discussion of the assignments, essays, and team presentations.

Point system used (i.e., how do course points translate into letter grades)

Points earned	93%-100%	90%-92%	87%-89%	83%-86%	80%-82%	77%-79%	73%-76%	70%-72%	67%-69%	63%-66%	60%-62%	Below 60%
Letter Grade	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	E

Please be aware that a C- is not an acceptable grade for graduate students. A grade of C counts toward a graduate degree only if an equal number of credits in courses numbered 5000 or higher have been earned with an A. In addition, the Bachelor of Health Science Program does not use C- grades.

Letter grade to grade point conversions are fixed by UF and cannot be changed

Letter Grade	**A**	**A-**	**B+**	**B**	**B-**	**C+**	**C**	**C-**	**D+**	**D**	**D-**	**E**	**WF**	**I**	**NG**	**S-U**
Grade Points	4.0	3.67	3.33	3.0	2.67	2.33	2.0	1.67	1.33	1.0	0.67	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

For greater detail on the meaning of letter grades and university policies related to them, see the Grading and Grade Policies posted by the Registrar's Office.

Exam Policy → Policy Related to Make up Essays or Other Work
Students will be allowed to make-up quizzes, assignments, and discussion board activities for acceptable reasons as described in the Graduate Catalog. See:
http://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/content.php?catoid=10&navoid=2020#attendance

If you are unable to submit an assignment on time, it is your responsibility to contact the instructor through email as soon as possible to request an alternate arrangement and due date. If an alternate arrangement is not requested or offered then no credit will be given for the assignment. Any approved make-up assignments should be submitted to the instructor through email.

Please note: Any requests for make-ups due to technical issues MUST be accompanied by the ticket number received from LSS when the problem was reported to them. The ticket number will document the time and date of the problem. You MUST e-mail me within 24 hours of the technical difficulty if you wish to request a make-up.

Attendance Policy → Policy Related to Late or Missed Class Attendance
This is an in-person course and therefore, attendance means you are expected to complete the course learning activities so that you meet the established deadlines. Please note all faculty are bound by the UF policy for excused absences.

Students are expected to be present, on time, and to participate in all class sessions. Students who know they will need to miss a class session should discuss this with the instructor prior to the date of the class or on the day of the absence for illness or emergency. According to the UF Catalog (link below): "*In general, acceptable reasons for absences from class include illness, serious family emergencies, special curricular requirements, military obligation, severe weather conditions, religious holidays, and*

participation in official University activities such as music performances, athletic competition or debate. Absences from class for court-imposed legal obligations (e.g., jury duty or subpoena) must be excused. Other reasons also may be approved."

*If student arrive 10 minutes late or leave 10 minutes before the end of class, without prior permission, this will be reflected in their class discussion grade.

For information regarding the UF Attendance Policy see the Registrar website for additional details: https://catalog.ufl.edu/ugrad/current/regulations/info/attendance.aspx

Excused absences must be consistent with university policies in the Graduate Catalog (https://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/graduate/regulations/#Attendance%20Policies). Additional information can be found here: https://catalog.ufl.edu/ugrad/current/regulations/info/attendance.aspx

Students who wish to drop from the course must do so by the drop/add deadline established by the Office of the University Registrar. Students must not assume they will be automatically dropped if they fail to participate in the course learning activities.

Classroom Policy → Policy Related to Classroom Conduct and Course Materials
Recordings. Students are allowed to record video or audio of class lectures. However, the purposes for which these recordings may be used are strictly controlled. The only allowable purposes are (1) for personal educational use, (2) in connection with a complaint to the university, or (3) as evidence in, or in preparation for, a criminal or civil proceeding. All other purposes are prohibited. Specifically, students may not publish recorded lectures without the written consent of the instructor.

A "class lecture" is an educational presentation intended to inform or teach enrolled students about a particular subject, including any instructor-led discussions that form part of the presentation, and delivered by any instructor hired or appointed by the University, or by a guest instructor, as part of a University of Florida course. A class lecture does not include lab sessions, student presentations, clinical presentations such as patient history, academic exercises involving solely student participation, assessments (quizzes, tests, exams), field trips, private conversations between students in the class or between a student and the faculty or lecturer during a class session.

Publication without permission of the instructor is prohibited. To "publish" means to share, transmit, circulate, distribute, or provide access to a recording, regardless of format or medium, to another person (or persons), including but not limited to another student within the same class section. Additionally, a recording, or transcript of a recording, is considered published if it is posted on or uploaded to, in whole or in part, any media platform, including but not limited to social media, book, magazine, newspaper, leaflet, or third-party note/tutoring services. A student who publishes a recording without written consent may be subject to a civil cause of action instituted by a person injured by the publication and/or discipline under UF Regulation 4.040 Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code.

Policy Related to Guests Attending Class. Only registered students are permitted to attend class. However, we recognize that students who are caretakers may face occasional unexpected challenges creating attendance barriers. Therefore, by exception, a department chair or his or her designee (e.g., instructors) may grant a student permission to bring a guest(s) for a total of two class sessions per semester. This is two sessions total across all courses. No further extensions will be granted. Students are responsible for course material regardless of attendance. For additional information, please review the Classroom Guests of Students policy in its entirety. Link to full policy: http://facstaff.phhp.ufl.edu/services/resourceguide/getstarted.htm

STUDENT EXPECTATIONS, ROLES, AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR INPUT
Expectations Regarding Course Behavior

Communication Guidelines
The preferred mode of communication with the course instructor is via email feature on Canvas or direct email. While emailing instructors, please make sure to copy both instructor and graduate assistant on the mail and always check the box, 'Send an individual message to each recipient". This way we can ensure prompt response to your emails.

Participation
Professional and respectful behavior is expected of all students participating in this course. Please be aware that all assignments and homework are due on the specified date and time.

Academic Integrity
Students are expected to act in accordance with the University of Florida policy on academic integrity. As a student at the University of Florida, you have committed yourself to uphold the Honor Code, which includes the following pledge:

"We, the members of the University of Florida community, pledge to hold ourselves and our peers to the highest standards of honesty and integrity."
You are expected to exhibit behavior consistent with this commitment to the UF academic community, and on all work submitted for credit at the University of Florida, the following pledge is either required or implied:

"On my honor, I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid in doing this assignment."
It is your individual responsibility to know and comply with all university policies and procedures regarding academic integrity and the Student Honor Code. Violations of the Honor Code at the University of Florida will not be tolerated. Violations will be reported to the Dean of Students Office for consideration of disciplinary action. For additional information regarding Academic Integrity, please see Student Conduct and Honor Codes information at the Dean of Students Office website or the Academic Expectations information at the Graduate School website for additional details.

https://www.dso.ufl.edu/sccr/process/student-conduct-honor-code/
https://graduateschool.ufl.edu/work/handbook/

Please remember cheating, lying, misrepresentation, or plagiarism in any form is unacceptable and inexcusable behavior.

Use of unauthorized assistance resources
As graduate students at the UF, you are expected to present your own work for grading. Unauthorized sources of help, including commercially available software and services, including any artificial intelligence sources, are not allowed. Even though the students will not be graded on their grammar, it is expected that as graduate students you will have sufficient English language skills to convey your thoughts in organized and understandable manner. If the assignment is unreadable, it will not be graded and will be assigned zero points. Use of unauthorized assistance sources will result in zero points on the written assignment and a report to the Dean of Student's Office. If you need assistance with English language and/or writing, you may visit the UF Writing Program Website to learn about available help. Online Faculty Course

Online Faculty Course Evaluation Process
Students are expected to provide professional and respectful feedback on the quality of instruction in this course by completing course evaluations online via GatorEvals. Guidance on how to give feedback in a professional and respectful manner is available at https://gatorevals.aa.ufl.edu/students/. Students will be notified when the evaluation period opens and can complete evaluations through the email they receive from GatorEvals, in their Canvas course menu under GatorEvals, or via https://ufl.bluera.com/ufl/ . Summaries of course evaluation results are available to students at https://gatorevals.aa.ufl.edu/public-results /.

SUPPORT SERVICES

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities
If you require classroom accommodation because of a disability, it is strongly recommended you register with the Dean of Students Office http://www.dso.ufl.edu within the first week of class or as soon as you believe you might be eligible for accommodations. The Dean of Students Office will provide documentation of accommodations to you, which you must then give to me as the instructor of the course to receive accommodations. Please do this as soon as possible after you receive the letter. Students with disabilities should follow this procedure as early as possible in the semester. The College is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to assist students in their

coursework.

Counseling and Student Health
Students sometimes experience stress from academic expectations and/or personal and interpersonal issues that may interfere with their academic performance. If you find yourself facing issues that have the potential to or are already negatively affecting your coursework, you are encouraged to talk with an instructor and/or seek help through University resources available to you.

- The **Counseling and Wellness Center** 352-392-1575 offers a variety of support services such as psychological assessment and intervention and assistance for math and test anxiety. Visit their web site for more information: http://www.counseling.ufl.edu. Online and in person assistance is available.
- **U Matter We Care** website: http://www.umatter.ufl.edu/. If you are feeling overwhelmed or stressed, you can reach out for help through the You Matter We Care website, which is staffed by Dean of Students and Counseling Center personnel.
- The **Student Health Care Center** at Shands is a satellite clinic of the main Student Health Care Center located on Fletcher Drive on campus. Student Health at Shands offers a variety of clinical services. The clinic is located on the second floor of the Dental Tower in the Health Science Center. For more information, contact the clinic at 392-0627 or check out the web site at: https://shcc.ufl.edu/
- Crisis intervention is always available 24/7 from:
    - Alachua County Crisis Center: (352) 264-6789 http://www.alachuacounty.us/DEPTS/CSS/CRISISCENTER/Pages/CrisisCenter.aspx
    - **University Police Department**: Visit UF Police Department website or call 352-392-1111 (or 9-1-1 for emergencies).
    - **UF Health Shands Emergency Room / Trauma Center:** For immediate medical care call 352-733-0111 or go to the emergency room at 1515 SW Archer Road, Gainesville, FL 32608; Visit the UF Health Emergency Room and Trauma Center website.

Do not wait until you reach a crisis to come in and talk with us. We have helped many students through stressful situations impacting their academic performance. You are not alone so do not be afraid to ask for assistance.

INCLUSIVE LEARNING ENVIRONMENT
Public health and health professions are based on the belief in human dignity and on respect for the individual. As we share our personal beliefs inside or outside of the classroom, it is always with the understanding that we value and respect diversity of background, experience, and opinion, where every individual feels valued. We believe in, and promote, openness and tolerance of differences in ethnicity and culture, and we respect differing personal, spiritual, religious and political values. We further believe that celebrating such diversity enriches the quality of the educational experiences we provide our students and enhances our own personal and professional relationships. We embrace The University of Florida's Non-Discrimination Policy, which reads, "The University shall actively promote equal opportunity policies and practices conforming to laws against discrimination. The University is committed to non-discrimination with respect to race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act." If you have questions or concerns about your rights and responsibilities for inclusive learning environment, please see your instructor or refer to the Center for Inclusion & Multicultural Engagement website: www.multicultural.ufl.edu

Campus Resources:
Academic Resources listed below

UF E-Learning Technical Support: https://elearning.ufl.edu/student-help/
352-392-4357 (select option 2) or email the support staff: learning-support@ufl.edu
Website above contains information for operating hours

UF Career Resource Center: https://career.ufl.edu
Located at the Reitz Union on campus.
Contact via phone (352-392-1601) or through email: UFCarerCenter@ufsa.ufl.edu

UF Health Science Library Support: https://library.health.ufl.edu/help/
Located within Communicore Building.
Contact via phone (352-273-8408) or through email: lib-hsclcirc@health.ufl.edu

UF Academic Support Services: https://umatter.ufl.edu/helping-students/academic-support/
This website includes the following UF resource topics → Academic Advising, Instructor Notifications, Requesting Accommodations, University Ombuds, First Generation Support, Transitioning to Campus

UF Graduate Student Success Center: https://success.grad.ufl.edu
This webpage contains multiple resources for professional, academic, and personal development and support.

UF University Writing Studio: https://writing.ufl.edu/writing-studio/
To make an appointment, visit the above website and follow scheduling instructions using your Gatorlink credentials as your log-in.

UF Teaching Center & CLAS Academic Resources: https://academicresources.clas.ufl.edu
Includes learning resources, tutoring information, language studio, supplemental instruction, and workshops.

UF Student Complaint Policy:
https://flexible.dce.ufl.edu/media/flexibledceufledu/documents/student_complaint_grievance_policy.pdf

UF Student Complaints & Grievances (online): https://flexible.dce.ufl.edu/student-complaints/

UF Online Distance Learning Program Student Complaints: https://pfs.tnt.aa.ufl.edu/state-authorization-status/#student-complaint

UF U Matter, We Care (refer or report any behavior or incident of concern): https://umatter.ufl.edu/refer-or-report/